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ARTICLE

The Dangerous Illusion Of "Safe" Christian Colleges - Parents Beware

Is It Really a Christian College?

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What Christian Parents Need to Know Before They Decide



BY PNW STAFF MAY 12, 2026

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A fresh wave of graduating seniors is about to walk across high school stages this spring, diplomas in hand and dreams of the future ahead of them. For many Christian families, one of the biggest decisions now looming is where those students will attend college. And for countless parents, the assumption still remains the same: a Christian college must surely be the safest and best place for a young believer to grow academically while also deepening their faith.

After all, these schools often promise biblical values, Christian community, chapel services, faith-based learning, and professors who supposedly teach through the lens of Scripture.

But increasingly, many Christian parents are discovering a troubling reality: not every college using the word "Christian" actually upholds a biblical worldview.

As families begin researching colleges this year, they must do far more than simply glance at mission statements or trust marketing brochures. In today's cultural climate, discernment has become essential because many institutions that still promote themselves as Christian are simultaneously embracing ideologies and practices that directly conflict with historic biblical teaching.

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Over the past several years, numerous Christian universities have found themselves embroiled in controversy over LGBTQ activism, drag performances, gender ideology, and theological compromise. What once would have been unthinkable at many Christian schools is now increasingly normalized.

Baylor University, one of the nation's best-known Baptist institutions, has repeatedly faced controversy surrounding LGBTQ issues on campus. Reports have highlighted disputes over pro-LGBTQ student events, activist groups, and growing pressure within the university to shift further away from traditional biblical teaching on sexuality. For many conservative Christian families, Baylor has become symbolic of the broader theological drift occurring inside portions of Christian higher education.

Meanwhile, some Catholic universities have gone even further, hosting "Lavender Graduation" ceremonies celebrating LGBTQ-identifying students. In several cases, reports have described drag performances connected to campus celebrations. Schools tied to these controversies reportedly include institutions such as Georgetown University, Seattle University, and Fordham University. These universities still prominently market their Christian heritage while simultaneously embracing movements many Christians believe openly contradict Scripture.

Other schools have faced similar criticism. Bethel College, a Mennonite-affiliated Christian college in Kansas, drew backlash after hosting annual drag shows on campus. Local residents and Christian critics questioned how a school rooted in historic Christian tradition could actively promote events that many believers view as fundamentally incompatible with biblical teaching. Yet defenders of the events framed them as expressions of inclusion and acceptance.



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Seattle Pacific University, a historically Free Methodist university, has also become a national flashpoint in the battle over Christian identity and sexuality. Years of internal conflict erupted as students and faculty pushed aggressively for LGBTQ affirmation and policy changes while university leadership attempted to maintain traditional biblical standards. Protests, sit-ins, lawsuits, and public division followed, exposing how deeply fractured many Christian institutions have become over core doctrinal issues.

And these examples are only scratching the surface.

Many Christian parents still operate under assumptions that may have been true decades ago but are far less reliable today. They see crosses on websites, Bible verses in promotional materials, and words like "faith-centered" or "Christ-centered" in advertisements and assume the institution remains firmly grounded in biblical truth.

But appearances can be deceiving.

Years ago, Christian researchers warned that many Christian colleges were already compromising foundational biblical doctrines beneath the surface. Ken Ham and Greg Hall's book *Already Compromised* documented research suggesting that many self-described Christian colleges had quietly embraced secular philosophies while continuing to market themselves as biblically faithful institutions.

According to the research, many professors at Christian colleges openly questioned the authority of Scripture, rejected biblical creation, embraced progressive theology, or promoted worldviews deeply influenced by secular academic culture.

Author Randy Alcorn later addressed what he called "false advertising by Christian colleges," warning that many parents would be stunned if they truly understood what some professors and departments actually believed behind classroom doors.

Sadly, the problem has only intensified with time.

Today's college campuses are not merely academic environments--they are worldview formation centers. Students are not only learning career skills. They are learning how to think about morality, sexuality, truth, identity, faith, and even the authority of God Himself.

That is why this issue matters so deeply.

Parents are not simply investing tens of thousands of dollars into an education. They are entrusting schools with the spiritual and intellectual shaping of their children during one of the most formative seasons of life.

And too many Christian families are doing so without asking hard questions.

What do the professors actually believe? What speakers are invited to campus? What student organizations are promoted? What worldview dominates the social atmosphere? How are biblical beliefs treated when they conflict with modern cultural trends? These are no longer optional questions for Christian parents--they are essential ones.

To be fair, not every Christian college has abandoned biblical conviction.

There are still schools that genuinely strive to uphold Scripture, cultivate authentic Christian community, and prepare students to serve Christ faithfully in their future careers. Strong Christian colleges still exist, and when families find the right one, the experience can be deeply valuable spiritually, academically, and personally.

A healthy Christian college can strengthen faith, encourage spiritual maturity, develop leadership, build lifelong Christian friendships, and prepare students to impact the culture rather than be consumed by it.

But families can no longer afford to assume that every institution carrying the "Christian" label actually offers that environment.

This year's graduating seniors are entering a world filled with confusion, competing ideologies, and intense pressure to compromise biblical convictions. Sadly, some of that pressure is now coming from institutions that still market themselves as Christian.

That is why parents must do their homework carefully.

Because choosing a college is no longer simply about finding the right degree program. It is about determining who and what will shape the heart, mind, and worldview of the next generation.

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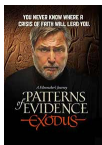
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